



Bard

Bards are weavers of magic and melody, skilled in shaping the world through sound, story, and rhythm. They move effortlessly between performance and action, turning music into influence, inspiration, or subtle chaos. Some bards uplift and heal, others sway the tides of nature or the seas, while a rare few manipulate harmony and dissonance to confound their enemies. In all their forms, bards are storytellers and tacticians, shaping both hearts and the battlefield with every note they play.

Hit Points

Hit Dice: 1d8 per Bard Level
Hit Points at 1st Level: 8 + your Constitution Modifier
Hit Points at Higher Levels: 1d8 (or 5) + your Constitution Modifier per Bard level after 1st

Equipment

- You start with the following equipment, in addition to the equipment granted by your background:
- (a) a greataxe or (b) any martial melee weapon
 - (a) two handaxes or (b) any simple weapon
 - An explorer's pack and four javelins

Proficiencies

Armor: Light Armor
Weapons: Simple weapons, hand crossbows, longswords, rapiers, shortswords
Tools: Three musical instruments of your choice
Saving Throws: Charisma, Dexterity
Skills: Choose any three

Bard Class Table					Bard Spell Slots								
Level	Proficiency Bonus	Class Feature	Cantrips Known	Spells Known	1st	2nd	3rd	4th	5th	6th	7th	8th	9th
1	+2	Spellcasting, Bardic Inspiration	2	4	2								
2	+2	Jack of All Trades, Song of Rest (d6)	2	5	3								
3	+2	Bardic College, Expertise	2	6	4	2							
4	+2	Ability Score Improvement	3	7	4	3							
5	+3	Bardic Inspiration (d8), Fon of Inspiration	3	8	4	3	2						
6	+3	Countercharm, Bard College Feature	3	9	4	3	3						
7	+3	--	3	10	4	3	3	1					
8	+3	Ability Score Improvement	3	11	4	3	3	2					
9	+4	Song of Rest (d8)	4	12	4	3	3	3	1				
10	+4	Bardic Inspiration (d10), Magical Secrets, Expertise	4	14	4	3	3	3	2				
11	+4	--	4	15	4	3	3	3	2	1			
12	+4	Ability Score Improvement	4	15	4	3	3	3	2	1			
13	+5	Song of Rest (d10)	4	16	4	3	3	3	2	1	1		
14	+5	Magical Secrets, Bard College Feature	4	18	4	3	3	3	2	1	1		
15	+5	Bardic Inspiration (d12)	4	19	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	1	
16	+5	Ability Score Improvement	4	19	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	1	
17	+6	Song of Rest (d12)	4	20	4	3	3	3	2	1	1	1	1
18	+6	Magical Secrets	4	22	4	3	3	3	3	1	1	1	1
19	+6	Ability Score Improvement	4	22	4	3	3	3	3	2	1	1	1
20	+6	Superior Inspiration	4	22	4	3	3	3	3	2	2	1	1



Bard Class Features

Spellcasting

You have learned to untangle and reshape the fabric of reality in harmony with your wishes and music. Your spells are part of your vast repertoire, magic that you can tune to different situations.

Cantrips

You know two cantrips of your choice from the bard spell list. You learn additional bard cantrips of your choice at higher levels, as shown in the Cantrips Known column of the Bard table.

Spell Slots

The Bard table shows how many spell slots you have to cast your bard spells of 1st level and higher. To cast one of these spells, you must expend a slot of the spell's level or higher. You regain all expended spell slots when you finish a long rest. For example, if you know the 1st-level spell Cure Wounds and have a 1st-level and a 2nd-level spell slot available, you can cast Cure Wounds using either slot.

Spells Known of 1st Level and Higher

You know four 1st-level spells of your choice from the bard spell list.

The Spells Known column of the Bard table shows when you learn more bard spells of your choice. Each of these spells must be of a level for which you have spell slots, as shown on the table. For instance, when you reach 3rd level in this class, you can learn one new spell of 1st or 2nd level.

Additionally, when you gain a level in this class, you can choose one of the bard spells you know and replace it with another spell from the bard spell list, which also must be of a level for which you have spell slots.

Spellcasting Ability

Charisma is your spellcasting ability for your bard spells. Your magic comes from the heart and soul you pour into the performance of your music or oration. You use your Charisma whenever a spell refers to your spellcasting ability. In addition, you use your Charisma modifier when setting the saving throw DC for a bard spell you cast and when making an attack roll with one.

Spell save DC = 8 + your proficiency bonus + your Charisma modifier

Spell attack modifier = your proficiency bonus + your Charisma modifier

Ritual Casting

You can cast any bard spell you know as a ritual if that spell has the ritual tag.

Spellcasting Focus

You can use a musical instrument (found in chapter 5) as a spellcasting focus for your bard spells.

Bardic Inspiration

You can inspire others through stirring words or music. To do so, you use a bonus action on your turn to choose one creature other than yourself within 60 feet of you who can hear you. That creature gains one Bardic Inspiration die, a d6.

Once within the next 10 minutes, the creature can roll the die and add the number rolled to one ability check, attack roll, or saving throw it makes. The creature can wait until after it rolls the d20 before deciding to use the Bardic Inspiration die, but must decide before the DM says whether the roll succeeds or fails. Once the Bardic Inspiration die is rolled, it is lost. A creature can have only one Bardic Inspiration die at a time.

You can use this feature a number of times equal to your Charisma modifier (a minimum of once). You regain any expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Your Bardic Inspiration die changes when you reach certain levels in this class. The die becomes a d8 at 5th level, a d10 at 10th level, and a d12 at 15th level.

Jack of All Trades

Starting at 2nd level, you can add half your proficiency bonus, rounded down, to any ability check you make that doesn't already include your proficiency bonus.



Bard Class Features

Song of Rest

Beginning at 2nd level, you can use soothing music or oration to help revitalize your wounded allies during a short rest. If you or any friendly creatures who can hear your performance regain hit points at the end of the short rest by spending one or more Hit Dice, each of those creatures regains an extra 1d6 hit points.

The extra Hit Points increase when you reach certain levels in this class: to 1d8 at 9th level, to 1d10 at 13th level, and to 1d12 at 17th level.

Primal Path

At 3rd level, you delve into the advanced techniques of a bard college of your choice. Your choice grants you features at 3rd level and again at 6th and 14th level.

Expertise

At 3rd level, choose two of your skill proficiencies. Your proficiency bonus is doubled for any ability check you make that uses either of the chosen proficiencies.

At 10th level, you can choose another two skill proficiencies to gain this benefit.

Ability Score Improvement

When you reach 4th level, and again at 8th, 12th, 16th, and 19th level, you can increase one ability score of your choice by 2, or you can increase two ability scores of your choice by 1. As normal, you can't increase an ability score above 20 using this feature.

Font of Inspiration

Beginning when you reach 5th level, you regain all of your expended uses of Bardic Inspiration when you finish a short or long rest.

Countercharm

At 6th level, you gain the ability to use musical notes or words of power to disrupt mind-influencing effects. As an action, you can start a performance that lasts until the end of your next turn. During that time, you and any friendly creatures within 30 feet of you have advantage on saving throws against being frightened or charmed. A creature must be able to hear you to gain this benefit. The performance ends early if you are incapacitated or silenced or if you voluntarily end it (no action required).

Magical Secrets

By 10th level, you have plundered magical knowledge from a wide spectrum of disciplines. Choose two spells from any classes, including this one. A spell you choose must be of a level you can cast, as shown on the Bard table, or a cantrip.

The chosen spells count as bard spells for you and are included in the number in the Spells Known column of the Bard table.

You learn two additional spells from any classes at 14th level and again at 18th level.

Superior Inspiration

At 20th level, when you roll initiative and have no uses of Bardic Inspiration left, you regain one use.



College of Sea Shanties

Bard Sub – Class

Sea shanties began as tools rather than performances. Long before they were sung for leisure, these songs were used to pace labor, steady nerves, and impose order on hostile environments. Crews hauling anchors or surging into combat learned early on that the right rhythm could mean the difference between survival and disaster. Over time, certain shantymen discovered that their voices carried more than morale. The wind shifted when they sang. Water parted or rose in time with the beat. What began as practical coordination hardened into a distinct magical tradition, passed from ship to ship, port to port, and eventually far beyond the coasts.

The most famous of these bards was Captain Maelin “Stormcall” Rourke, a sailor remembered less for his battles and more for the impossible voyages he survived. Stormcall was said to sing during hurricanes, his voice cutting through the roar of the storm as crew and ship alike seemed to move in perfect time with him. Records claim he calmed the seas long enough to walk an entire crew across a flooded strait, guided ships through fog so dense it swallowed sound, and once turned a headwind into a roaring gale at his back to outrun a pursuing armada. Whether every tale is true matters less than the legacy he left behind: proof that a song, sung at the right moment, could command the sea itself.

Level 3 - Shantyman’s Reserve

You learn additional spells at certain bard levels, shown on the Sea Shanty Spells table. These spells count as bard spells for you and do not count against the number of bard spells you know. These spells are often accompanied by a rousing beat or melodic tune, an activity that the shipmates often feel inclined to join in on.

Sea Shanty Spells List	
Bard Level	Spells Learned
3rd	Shape Water, Fog Cloud
6th	Gust of Wind, Water Walk
9th	Water Breathing, Wind Wall
14th	Control Water
17th	Control Weather

Level 3 - Work Song Momentum

When you cast a spell of 1st level or higher that affects terrain, movement, or visibility (such as longstrider, entangle, darkvision), or any spell on the Sea Shanty Spells List, you can expend one Bardic Inspiration die to reinforce it.

Choose one reinforcement to apply:

- One creature affected by the spell gains temporary hit points equal to your Bardic Inspiration die roll + your Charisma modifier.
- One creature affected by the spell may immediately move up to 15 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.
- The area of effect is increased by 5 ft. If the spell does not affect an area to increase, this effect does nothing.
- The duration is doubled. If the effect is instantaneous, this effect does nothing.

Level 6 - Steady Sea Legs

You and creatures of your choice within 30 feet that can hear you have advantage on saving throws against being knocked prone, pushed, restrained, or grappled.

In addition, when a creature within 60 feet that can hear you fails a Strength or Dexterity saving throw, you may use your reaction to allow it to reroll the save and take the new result. You can use this reaction a number of times equal to your Charisma modifier per long rest.

Level 14 - Distortion Loop

At 14th level, you can unleash your ultimate shanty, turning rhythm into a surge of morale and coordination. When you use this feature, choose up to 10 creatures within 60 feet who can hear you. When you do:

Each affected ally gains temporary hit points equal to $3 \times$ your Charisma modifier.

Each affected ally may immediately move up to 15 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.

Creatures of your choice within 15 feet of you must make a Constitution saving throw against your spell save DC. On a failed save, they are distracted and shaken, suffering disadvantage on attack rolls until the end of their next turn.

Sustained Performance: On each of your subsequent turns, you may use your action to expend 2 hit dice and repeat this effect. Once you finish the final turn of your sustained performance (or end it by skipping a turn), you can’t use All Hands on Deck again until you finish a long rest.



College of Discordant Chaos

Bard Sub-Class

Bards of the College of Discordant Chaos practice a style of music that most performers find uncomfortable. Their art focuses on dissonance, strange timing, and sounds that refuse to settle into a pleasing pattern. Rather than calming a crowd or lifting spirits, their performances unsettle the mind and make it difficult to concentrate. Listeners often feel as though something is slightly wrong with the rhythm of the world around them. In battle this effect becomes a powerful tool, causing enemies to hesitate, mistime their strikes, or struggle to hold a spell together.

Stories about the origin of the college point to an unusual gathering of experimental musicians many years ago. The performers had come together to explore the magical nature of sound, but their work soon drifted into unfamiliar territory. They began deliberately combining rhythms that should not work together and discovered that the resulting vibrations interfered with concentration in a very real way. What began as an eccentric experiment slowly developed into a discipline. Students who learned these techniques refined them over time until the strange art gained a name and a following, forming what is now known as the College of Discordant Chaos.

Those who follow this tradition rarely see themselves as destructive musicians. To them, discord is simply another form of musical truth. Where other bards rely on harmony to inspire courage, these performers understand how sound can interrupt thought and fracture focus. Among adventuring parties they often serve as disruptors, using their strange rhythms to undermine opponents while their allies take advantage of the confusion. The battlefield becomes a stage where even a small shift in timing can change the outcome of a fight.

Level 3 - Discordant Field

As an action, you can expend a Bardic Inspiration die to create a Discordant Field instead of aiding an ally. Choose a point you can see within 60 feet. A 10-foot sphere of disharmonizing, discordant tunes appears. Whenever a creature starts their turn in the field or moves into the field for the first time on their turn, it must make a Constitution saving throw against your spell save DC. On a failed save, it subtracts your Bardic Inspiration die from all attack rolls and saving throws until the start of its next turn.

The field lasts for 1 minute, provided you use a Bonus Action on each subsequent turn to maintain the field. Ending your turn without maintaining the field will cause it to end immediately.

At 3rd level, you can maintain 1 field at a time.

Additionally, at 3rd level, you learn the Counterspell spell. It counts as a bard spell for you, but it does not count against the number of bard spells you know. Once per long rest, you may cast this spell without expending a spell slot.

Level 6 - Harmonized Interference

At 6th level, your Discordant Field expands to a 15ft radius. Additionally at 6th level, you may shield allies from the effects of your discordance. Whenever a creature starts their turn in your Discordant Field or moves into it for the first time on their turn, you may choose whether they are affected by the field or not.

Level 14 - Distortion Loop

Starting at 14th level, you're able to maintain up to 2 Discordant Fields at the same time. While two fields are active, maintaining the fields requires an Action each round instead of a Bonus Action. Creatures that are entirely contained in both fields (if they overlap) that fail their Constitution saves take 2d4 psychic damage in addition to the standard Discordant Field effects.





College of Natural Rhythm

Bardic Sub-Class

Bards of the College of Natural Rhythm follow a tradition that predates written music and crafted instruments. Long before strings were stretched across wood or pipes were carved for song, people made music with their own bodies. Hands struck skin, feet pounded the ground, and breath carried simple patterns that echoed through gatherings and rituals. These early rhythms were not written or taught in formal lessons. They were learned by listening to the body and to the steady pulse that seems to run through every living thing.

Practitioners of this college train themselves to recognize and answer that pulse. They clap, stomp, snap, slap their chests, and shape sounds with their voices in rapid succession. The style can look playful or even chaotic to an outsider, yet every motion follows a precise sense of timing. In battle these bards move like living percussion, their rhythm guiding their allies and sharpening their own reflexes. A sudden clap can punctuate a strike at exactly the right moment, while a rapid series of beats can push companions to act with perfect coordination.

No one can point to a single founder for this tradition because it never truly began at a specific time. Versions of it appear anywhere people gather and find a beat in their own bodies. Travelers have found similar styles in distant villages that have never met, each with its own patterns yet sharing the same instinct. To the bards who study Natural Rhythm, this is proof that the music they follow is older than any school or performance hall. It has always been there, waiting in the steady cadence of breath and heartbeat for someone willing to listen.

Level 3 - Instrumental Body

Your body itself becomes a valid musical focus. You never require a musical instrument to use Bard features or cast Bard spells. You may use percussive movement, vocal rhythm, or breath as your spellcasting focus. You may perform Bardic Inspiration even while restrained or prone, as long as you can produce sound. When you roll initiative, you may immediately grant Bardic Inspiration to a number of creatures you can see within 30 feet equal to your Charisma modifier (minimum 1) without expending uses of Bardic Inspiration. A creature cannot gain more than one Bardic Inspiration die from this feature.

Additionally, immediately after a creature uses one of your Bardic Inspiration dice and succeeds on the roll, you may produce a sharp rhythmic cue—such as a clap, stomp, or beatbox accent. One creature of your choice that can hear you within 30 feet may move up to 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.

Level 6 - Destructive Soundblasts

Your sense of timing allows you to interrupt the force of an impact with a perfectly placed beat. When a creature you can see within 30 feet takes damage, you may use your reaction to roll your Bardic Inspiration die and reduce the damage by the number rolled. You must have at least one Bardic Inspiration die remaining to use this feature, but the die is not expended. If the damage includes bludgeoning, thunder, or force, roll the Bardic Inspiration die twice and use the higher result.

You may use this feature a number of times equal to your Charisma modifier, and you regain all expended uses when you finish a long rest.

Level 14 - Everybody Dance Now

You can turn a single beat into a shared surge of rhythm. As a bonus action, you begin a loud, infectious rhythmic performance. When you do, choose any number of creatures that can hear you within 60 feet, up to a maximum equal to half your bard level (rounded down). Each chosen creature may immediately use its reaction to clap, stomp, chant, or otherwise join in. If at least one creature joins in, the following effects occur immediately:

- Each creature that joined in gains temporary hit points equal to $5 \times$ the total number of creatures who joined in.
- Each creature that joined in may immediately move up to 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.
- Each creature that joined in ends any effect causing it to be charmed or frightened.

Once you use this feature, you can't do so again until you finish a long rest.





College of Grace

Bard Sub-Class

The College of Grace traces its roots back to the earliest traditions of dance and performance. Early performers discovered that the precision and focus required for intricate footwork could be transformed into a practical skill: a way to defend oneself and others while moving with elegance and purpose. Over generations, these performers refined their steps into forms of combat, learning to turn intricate and beautiful spins patterns into defensive maneuvers and precise strikes. What began as entertainment gradually evolved into a disciplined art form where dance and martial skill were inseparable.

As this tradition developed, practitioners began experimenting with tools to extend their artistry. Blades hidden in shoes or reinforced boots allowed dancers to combine their natural fluidity with deadly precision.. The rhythms of dance became a language of combat: timing and positioning were as important as strength or skill. Today, bards of the College of Grace are trained to master this discipline, blending footwork, agility, and musical rhythm into a seamless expression of artistry and martial effectiveness, turning the battlefield itself into a stage.

Level 3 - Inspiring Grace

When you attack with a finesse or light melee weapon, you may expend one Bardic Inspiration die to add it to the damage roll. Additionally, a creature that has one of your Bardic Inspiration dice gains temporary HP equal to your Bard level at the end of their turn if they move at least 10 feet on their turn.

Level 3 - Foot Blades

You gain one foot blade, a finesse light melee weapon (1d6 piercing, Dex-based), that can be used as a melee weapon when taking the Attack action. Your movement speed increases by 10 feet so long as you are not wearing Medium or Heavy armor. If you move at least 10 feet on your turn before taking the Attack action, you may expend one Bardic Inspiration die to make one additional melee attack with your foot blade when you take that action.

Level 6 - Evasive Flourish

When a creature hits you with a melee attack, you may use your reaction and expend a Bardic Inspiration die to add it to your AC, potentially causing the attack to miss.

Additionally, when you take damage from an attack, you may use your reaction to roll a Bardic Inspiration die without expending it and subtract that amount from the damage. You must have at least one Bardic Inspiration die available to use this ability.

Level 14 - Dance of Blades

As an action, you whirl and spin in a beautiful presentation of grace. Make a melee weapon attack using your foot blades against each enemy within 10 feet. You may spend one Bardic Inspiration die per target to add the roll to the damage.

Immediately after, you may move up to half your speed without provoking opportunity attacks. Additionally, you gain resistance to bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing damage until the start of your next turn.

Once finished, this feature cannot be used again until you finish a short or long rest.

